

China Autonomous Driving Industry Quarterly Data Briefing — Q2 2026

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What's Inside

本期关键词

L2 penetration reaches 70.5% — NOA exceeds 30%

First mandatory national standard for L2 systems issued — takes effect January 1, 2027

24 financing events raise RMB 35 billion+ in H1

L3 pilot operations expand across Beijing, Shanghai, Chongqing, Wuhan

XPeng launches China's first mass-produced Robotaxi

Global L2 penetration to reach 57.3% by 2031, L2+ to hit 31%

Three numbers that matter

L2-level combined driving assistance penetration reached 70.5% in H1 2026, with NOA-equipped models exceeding 30%. China has become the world's largest intelligent driving market.

H1 2026 autonomous driving financing exceeded RMB 35 billion across 24 publicly disclosed deals, surpassing full-year 2023 (RMB 20 billion) and 2024

levels. Horizon Robotics raised an additional HK\$11 billion through two post-IPO placements.

L3 penetration in China's passenger car market is projected at approximately 1% in 2026, corresponding to about 257,000 units. The gap between L2+ 普及 and L3 adoption highlights the industry's most critical bottleneck.

What changed this quarter

First mandatory national standard for L2 driving assistance systems (GB 47955—2026) officially issued

L3 autonomous driving pilots expanded to Shanghai, Beijing, Chongqing, and Wuhan

XPeng launched China's first factory-installed mass-produced Robotaxi

Two L3 models received market access permits in late 2025, with pilots now underway

Part 1: Market Penetration & Adoption

1.1 L2 Penetration

According to MIIT data, L2-level combined driving assistance penetration in new passenger vehicles reached **70.5% in H1 2026**. MIIT Chief Engineer Wang

Weiming confirmed at a State Council press conference on July 20 that the penetration rate had reached **70%**.

April 2026 data from Gasgoo shows:

Standard L2 penetration: **73.32%**

L2+ and above: just over **41%**

NEV segment: Among new energy passenger vehicles, L2 systems accounted for **58.2%** in the first four months of 2026, with L2+ at **29.2%** — combined L2/L2+ installation rate reaching **87.4%**. L2+ penetration increased by **7.5 percentage points** year-over-year.

By price tier:

Price Range	L2+ Share (2025)	L2+ Share (2026)
Above RMB 400,000	45.2%	69%
RMB 160,000–240,000	—	22.1%

Source: China Passenger Car Association

1.2 NOA Penetration

NOA (Navigate on Autopilot) penetration exceeded **30%** in H1 2026. City NOA is expanding from RMB 300,000+ vehicles down to the RMB 100,000–150,000 price segment.

1.3 L3 Penetration

L3 adoption remains limited. Daiwa Securities estimates L3 penetration in China's passenger car market at approximately **1% in 2026**, corresponding to about **257,000 units**.

L3 pilots: Two models received market access permits in late 2025 — Changan Deepal SL03 and BAIC Arcfox αS — approved for pilot operations in designated areas of Chongqing and Beijing. L3 pilots are now underway in Shanghai, Beijing, Chongqing, and Wuhan.

1.4 Global Outlook

Berg Insight's Global ADAS & Autonomous Driving Vehicle Market report projects:

L2 penetration globally will reach **57.3%** by 2031

L2+ penetration will rise from **9.2% to 31.0%**

L3 vehicles will exceed **1 million units** for the first time

1.5 The "Usage Gap"

Despite high hardware penetration, actual usage remains low. Huawei estimates **fewer than 10% of users** have actually used assisted driving features — most are hesitant or unfamiliar. Huawei's Qiankun 累计 assisted

driving mileage reached **12.35 billion km** as of June 30, 2026, with 97.5% of semi-annual active users.

Part 2: Policy & Regulatory Developments (Q2 2026)

2.1 First Mandatory National Standard for L2 Systems

On June 27, MIIT issued the **mandatory national standard Intelligent Connected Vehicles — Safety Requirements for Combined Driving Assistance Systems** (GB 47955—2026).

Effective date: January 1, 2027

Key provisions:

Category	Requirements
System Classification	Three types: Basic Single-Lane, Basic Multi-Lane, and NOA (Navigate on Autopilot) — each with clearly defined capability boundaries
Human-Machine Interface	Clear delineation that L2 is assistive only; driver bears primary responsibility
Data Recording	Mandatory data recording systems to capture full activation process — traceable and verifiable
Testing Methods	Multi-level evaluation including field tests, road tests, and document inspections

Industry impact:

Nearly **40 companies** participated in drafting, including Huawei, Xiaomi, BYD, and Tesla

Compliance testing now covers **extreme scenarios**: rain/fog, tunnels, nighttime glare

The standard eliminates marketing claims, requiring clear functional boundaries

2.2 Autonomous Driving System Safety Standard (In Progress)

MIIT completed drafting the Intelligent Connected Vehicles — Autonomous Driving System Safety Requirements mandatory national standard, with the draft and commentary publicly circulated from June 17–24, 2026.

2.3 2026 Automotive Standardization Work Priorities

MIIT's 2026 Automotive Standardization Work Priorities includes:

Promoting issuance and implementation of mandatory national standards for combined driving assistance systems

Pushing for issuance and implementation of mandatory national standards for autonomous driving systems and simulation testing methods

2.4 L3 Regulatory Framework

MIIT approved **two L3 models for road pilots in 2025**. Under current plans, **2026 will see the phased rollout of approvals and road access for additional L3 models**, with the relevant regulatory framework gradually taking shape.

L3 testing licenses: By March 2026, multiple mainstream brands had obtained L3 autonomous driving test/special licenses. Nationwide, over **16,000** autonomous driving road test licenses have been issued.

2.5 Pilot Zones & Testing

Beijing E-Town: Beijing's high-level autonomous driving demonstration zone upgraded to Version 3.0, expanding coverage from 60 km² to **600 km²**, issuing test licenses to **35 companies** and **over 1,000 vehicles**, with test mileage exceeding **38 million km**. In July 2026, Beijing E-Town was approved as one of Beijing's four municipal future industry pilot zones, covering the entire **225 km²** area.

Kunming: Cumulative 开放 autonomous driving test roads of **254.4 km**, issued **240 test licenses**, with **72 vehicles** in regular operation and cumulative test mileage exceeding **46,000 km**.

Shenzhen: Pingshan District issued an Administrative Measures for Intelligent Connected Vehicle Full-Area Open Testing, Demonstration Applications, and